

Game Programmer

Christian Thielsch

ch.thielsch@gmail.com

chthielsch.github.io

Game programmer with around eight years of experience, focused on gameplay and systems, with some tool development along the way. I've shipped two games and have worked primarily in small to medium-sized teams, where broad ownership and close collaboration are part of everyday work.

Eligible to work in the EU and Canada, open to relocation.

Experience

Lead Game Developer *Critical Rabbit*

11/2025 - Present

Unannounced Project full-time

- Prototyping new systems and gameplay concepts for narrative driven gameplay
- Setting up team structure and development workflows
- Guiding technical direction and mentoring developers
- Ensuring maintainable, scalable gameplay systems

Tech Stack Unity, C#, Visual Studio, Flutter, Dart, Figma, Git, Notion

Shelfies (B2B) full-time

- Sole programmer for audiobook app for major German publisher
- Implemented audiobook playback, library management and NFC scanning for deep linking
- Integrated server calls with custom API for data handling

Senior Game Programmer *European Space Agency*

02/2025 - 10/2025

ESA SHIELD contract

- Served as technical lead for grand-scale management game
- Designed and implemented core Unity project architecture
- Coordinated workflows and managed task planning across dev team
- Handled PC and mobile build preparation and deployment

Tech Stack Unity, C#, Visual Studio, Git, Jira

Gameplay Developer *Critical Rabbit*

01/2021 - 08/2024

Fall of Porcupine full-time

- Developed core gameplay systems, character controller, and minigames
- Handled porting and launch to Switch, PS5, Xbox Series, Steam, GOG, and Epic Games Store
- Managed localization into 7 languages
- Coordinated with external testing company and platform holders
- Guided junior team members and reviewed implementations

Tech Stack Unity, C#, Visual Studio, Git, Trello, Mantis Bug Tracker

Game Programmer *Ahoiii Entertainment*

03/2020 - 10/2020

Fiete PlaySchool freelance

- Collaborated with designers to implement educational gameplay mechanics
- Prototyped features and iterated on concepts for young audiences
- Conducted profiling and optimized existing codebase to improve performance
- Wrote unit tests for scalability and responsiveness

Tech Stack Unity, C#, Visual Studio, Unity Version Control

Education

Bachelor of Science Games Programming
Middlesex University, London (10 / 2019)

Languages

German: Native language
English: Bilingual (C2)